

limit access to folders from other non-administrator users. Right-click on a folder, select Properties, and set the “Make Private” option to protect your folders from unauthorised access by others.

2.8. Turn off or disable the Guest Account

If your computer is a standalone system that only connects to the Internet, you should disable / turn off the guest account—just so people you haven’t given out your password to won’t be able to access your computer. The Guest Account is also used to allow unauthenticated users from a LAN to access shared folders and files on your computer.

Go to **Control Panel > User Accounts**. To delete the Guest Account, just select it and hit Remove. However, it is better to disable it as there is a chance that you may require the account at some point in the future.

Select the Advanced tab and click Advanced. In the “Local Users and Groups” window, select the Users branch of the tree in the left pane. Right-click on the Guest Account and select Properties. In the resulting dialog box, select the “Account is Disabled” checkbox. The Guest account will no longer be accessible for logging on either locally or from another computer on the network. Note that this procedure may vary slightly for Windows XP Home.

2.9. Delete / Disable Unused User Accounts

Earlier, users of your system may have left their accounts on the system. This can be another avenue for potential security compromise—if these users gain access to your system and use it for a malicious purpose. If the users are temporarily not using their accounts, disable them, else delete